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IN THE CIRCUIT COURT
OF THE EIGHTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR ALACHUA COUNTY, FLORIDA

CHRISTOPHER A. HANSON,
Individually and as attorney
for himself and next friend
and attorney for his two
minor children, Case No. 01-2026-CA-001794

Petitioners,

-vs-

UNIVERSITY OF FLORIDA BOARD
OF TRUSTEES and CUSTODIAN OF
PUBLIC RECORDS, UNIVERSITY OF
FLORIDA,

Defendants.

_____/

HEARING BEFORE: HONORABLE DONNA M. KEIM
DATE TAKEN: Monday, August 24, 2026
TIME: 11:00 a.m. to 11:37 a.m.
PLACE: Via Videoconference
REPORTED BY: Mary Ann Browne, FPR
Notary Public

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(1) APPEARANCES:

(2) CHRISTOPHER A. HANSON, ESQUIRE

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[REDACTED]

(4)

Appearing on behalf of the Petitioners

(5)

(6) JAMES W. KIRKCONNELL, ESQUIRE

University of Florida General Counsel

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(8) jameswk@ufl.edu

(9) Appearing on behalf of the Respondents

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(1) THE COURT: We are here in the
(2) Christopher Hanson v. University of Florida
(3) Board of Trustees case.

(4) I will just note, Mr. Hanson, your
(5) appearance and Mr. Kirkconnell's appearance
(6) for the Defendant. We do have a court
(7) reporter present.

(8) I have reviewed the motions that were
(9) filed. And I was actually just advising
(10) Mr. Kirkconnell, Mr. Hanson, that the
(11) Respondent's Motion to Dispense is well
(12) taken.

(13) My assistant usually would not
(14) schedule a case management conference on a
(15) case involving a writ of mandamus.

(16) That was done in response to a
(17) request, I think from you, to schedule a
(18) case management, but it's certainly not
(19) something that would be done.

(20) So you are not entitled to a case
(21) management conference regarding this. The
(22) proper procedure would have been just to
(23) schedule it for a hearing.

(24) So I am going to grant that motion to
(25) dismiss.

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(1) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, may I have
(2) the opportunity to make a record? I
(3) suppose it will come up on the other motion
(4) as well.

(5) THE COURT: A record? I mean, do you
(6) have some legal authority that you're
(7) entitled to a case management conference?

(8) MR. HANSON: Well, I'm not so much
(9) concerned about the case management
(10) conference, Your Honor. I'm just concerned
(11) about the discovery issue.

(12) I don't know if there's anything that
(13) goes along with what your ruling is beyond
(14) just the case management conference.

(15) THE COURT: Sure. I specifically just
(16) ruled on the Respondent's Motion to
(17) Dispense with Rule 1.200 Case Management
(18) Conference, because the case management
(19) procedures do not apply to this type of
(20) case. So that motion is granted.

(21) I'm sorry that that happened. I was
(22) explaining that there was an error on the
(23) part of my assistant. She just responded
(24) to a request for a case management.

(25) Usually she would not do that, but it

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(1) happened. So I apologize that that was
(2) scheduled. That was a mistake on the part
(3) of the Court.

(4) MR. HANSON: And Your Honor, if I may.
(5) The motion from Mr. Kirkconnell suggests
(6) that the case management requirements be
(7) waived and set an evidentiary hearing to
(8) determine the University's compliance with
(9) Chapter 119 as soon as possible and grant
(10) any other relief it deems proper.

(11) My only concern on that is to the
(12) extent that it may obstruct me from getting
(13) discovery.

(14) So I would ask that --

(15) THE COURT: That's a separate issue,
(16) and I'm happy to address that. That's also
(17) noticed for today.

(18) So we'll go ahead and move on to that,
(19) which is Respondent's Motion for Protective
(20) Order.

(21) I have reviewed all of the pleadings
(22) filed in the case. I will say that the
(23) Motion for Protective Order is well taken.

(24) Mr. Kirkconnell, do you have anything
(25) that you would like to add to the Motion?

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(1) MR. KIRKCONNELL: No, ma'am. I trust
(2) the Court. I've practiced before Your
(3) Honor many times.

(4) You're very well-informed on the
(5) issues and the facts. So I have nothing
(6) more to add at this point.

(7) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, you may
(8) respond.

(9) MR. HANSON: Yes, Your Honor. I have
(10) quite a bit that I need to go through here.
(11) I can tell already that I have some very
(12) serious concerns about the way the Court is
(13) handling this.

(14) There is a massive problem with
(15) corruption in Florida's courts and my
(16) children have suffered because of it.

(17) You seem like you're very quick to
(18) push this under the rug, like the
(19) University of Florida wants.

(20) And it's not really debatable whether
(21) there is misconduct here and dishonesty and
(22) hypocrisy at the highest levels.

(23) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, what I'm going
(24) to do, you're pro se, so you're
(25) representing yourself.

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(1) You're certainly welcome to do that,
(2) but you are held to the same standard as an
(3) attorney.

(4) So what I'm going to remind you is
(5) that right now we're proceeding on the
(6) Respondent's Motion for Protective Order,
(7) and I'd like you to limit your arguments to
(8) that particular motion.

(9) MR. HANSON: But all of this is part
(10) of my argument, Your Honor.

(11) THE COURT: I would disagree. So if
(12) you would limit your argument to the
(13) specific Motion for Protective Order and
(14) the issues raised there.

(15) MR. HANSON: Well, we need to look at
(16) the course of actions from the University
(17) of Florida.

(18) So the underlying problem that I'm
(19) having is corruption in the Thirteenth
(20) Circuit Court and the Sixth Circuit Court,
(21) with judges in the Sixth Circuit protecting
(22) the Thirteenth Circuit as they conceal
(23) evidence in my underlying case in order to
(24) retaliate against me.

(25) I have a lawsuit against Judge Felix

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(1) who is presiding over my underlying case.
(2) And the Sixth Circuit judges were appointed
(3) as conflict judges, because the Thirteenth
(4) Circuit judges can't proceed over the
(5) mandamus case against the Thirteenth
(6) Circuit, but constitutional due process
(7) would require that Judge Felix disqualify
(8) himself due to the direct structural
(9) conflict where we have -- there's
(10) contentious litigation where my position is
(11) there's no good-faith position for the
(12) Thirteenth Circuit's defenses.

(13) And the Sixth Circuit judges, first
(14) Judge Frayman and then Judge Coleman, they
(15) are openly corrupt and are sacrificing the
(16) welfare of my family to protect judges who
(17) have been dishonest and biased from
(18) accountability.

(19) So I think it's a pretty serious
(20) problem, because I see the impact it has on
(21) my kids everyday, because this corrupt
(22) court has trapped me in proceedings.

(23) Your Honor, I've said all of this
(24) publicly. I've said it to the judges.
(25) I've said it to the Florida Bar, because

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(1) it's all true.

(2) So I don't have any concern about what
(3) you or anyone else will do for me telling
(4) the truth.

(5) I've got a lot more concern about not
(6) telling the truth or letting the truth get
(7) suppressed here.

(8) So that's the underlying problem.
(9) There's a serious corruption issue in the
(10) Thirteenth Circuit and the Sixth Circuit
(11) and the Florida Bar as well. They've
(12) hidden evidence as well.

(13) I approached the Brechner Institute on
(14) March 12th of 2026 about help with it. I
(15) had already been in touch with some
(16) journalists who were initially very
(17) interested, but then it seemed that they
(18) got pushed off of it.

(19) They wouldn't have an explanation for
(20) suddenly changing their position to their
(21) interests in the story to they can't touch
(22) it or they would tell me things that made
(23) no sense logically.

(24) So it has been really frustrating,
(25) because the courts have betrayed me with

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(1) dishonesty and insider protectionism that
(2) trumps the welfare of my kids, which is
(3) just true.

(4) And then the journalists seem to be
(5) connected with the courts. They seem to be
(6) protecting the courts, which is a pretty
(7) enormous problem in my view, especially
(8) with things that have gone on in the
(9) national media and divisiveness in our
(10) country and the lack of confidence in
(11) government and courts, while all of this is
(12) happening to an attorney who has called it
(13) out every step of the way, and every judge
(14) sweeps it under the rug.

(15) The Florida Bar tried to sweep it
(16) under the rug. There's video of Judge
(17) Ayers, the underlying judge in the
(18) Thirteenth Circuit Court who is now
(19) disqualified and Felix took over.

(20) There's video of her showing bias,
(21) rolling her eyes at me, over me just trying
(22) to protect the welfare of my kids.

(23) When I called her on it, she
(24) immediately lied about it and then she
(25) offered to get the video. She offered to

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(1) get the video and prove that she was
(2) telling the truth.

(3) So I called her on that. I said,
(4) please get the video, and I've asked ever
(5) since.

(6) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, I hate to cut
(7) you off. I understand that you have a long
(8) history, it sounds like a very long history
(9) that you want to give me, but we have a
(10) half an hour set today for three motions.

(11) I've already dealt with the first
(12) motion, but the motion that I'm listening
(13) to and I'm waiting for you to make an
(14) argument specifically about is the
(15) University's Motion for Protective Order.

(16) So you've asked for discovery.
(17) They've provided a legal argument as to why
(18) you're not entitled to that discovery, and
(19) I'd like for you to specifically respond to
(20) that motion.

(21) If you want to give me the whole
(22) history of all of your litigation, half an
(23) hour is probably not enough time, and I
(24) don't think it's at all relevant to this
(25) specific issue on the protective order.

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(1) MR. HANSON: Well, Your Honor, I was
(2) just trying to get into that. So when I
(3) contacted them on March 12th, I already had
(4) these severe ongoing problems with Freedom
(5) of Information.

(6) As an attorney, I've litigated them I
(7) would say about perfectly. I don't know
(8) any fault that someone can find in any of
(9) the litigation that I've pursued against
(10) the Thirteenth Circuit or the Florida Bar,
(11) but the Brechner Institute and the people I
(12) was in touch with were suspiciously
(13) dismissive and I would say even informed
(14) about my case before I spoke about it.

(15) So it immediately raised red flags for
(16) me, especially with the history of the
(17) case. And the appearance impact that the
(18) judiciary has on the media, it was very
(19) concerning.

(20) So they blew me off around March 12th.
(21) March 12th was my first contact, and it was
(22) within a few days that they blew me off.

(23) So on March 26th, I sent a public
(24) records request to the University of
(25) Florida.

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(1) Immediately the University of Florida
(2) was very much on top of this. I don't know
(3) if you received my filing from this morning
(4) or my e-mail to your assistant, Ms. Hall,
(5) earlier.

(6) THE COURT: I would not. Sir, I would
(7) not have received anything filed this
(8) morning. My Division procedures require
(9) that everything be provided seven days
(10) prior to the hearing. I've been in court
(11) all morning. So I haven't seen it.

(12) MR. HANSON: Okay. Well, I hope that
(13) you will take the time to review it. I'll
(14) go through some of it here.

(15) So I sent the public records request
(16) on March 26th. Almost immediately, also on
(17) March 26th, the records custodian for the
(18) University of Florida, John Hines, he
(19) e-mails Mr. Kirkconnell and Amy Quillen,
(20) who is also part of the general counsel's
(21) office moments after I sent the public
(22) records request to the University of
(23) Florida.

(24) It's already in the records
(25) custodian's hands and then going to general

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(1) counsel.

(2) And Mr. Hines writes, "Can we discuss
(3) this one at our meeting on Monday"? So I
(4) don't know why if the University of Florida
(5) has been forthcoming and they just provided
(6) their responsive records, why the records
(7) custodian is asking for a meeting with the
(8) two members of the general counsel's office
(9) moments after they received my request.

(10) It seems like it was a more important
(11) request, that there's something going on
(12) here that the University of Florida doesn't
(13) want to talk about.

(14) That was a Thursday. That's Thursday,
(15) March 26th. On March 30th is a Monday.
(16) And nothing happens from March 26th from
(17) when Mr. Hines, the records custodian,
(18) contacts general counsel, but then on
(19) Monday, I assume it's after the meeting
(20) that Mr. Hines had with general counsel,
(21) but that's an important question to have
(22) answered, and that's why I need discovery.

(23) The University of Florida seems to be
(24) taking the position that you can't prove
(25) that we actually have more records and

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(1) we're not going to have to answer any
(2) questions about it.

(3) It's a circular argument. They're
(4) placing the ball in the Court's hands to
(5) protect them. There's no good-faith basis
(6) for them to avoid discovery in this case.

(7) I'll continue on with their course of
(8) action, which it gets even more egregious,
(9) but that's pretty suspicious, just the
(10) immediate involvement of general counsel.

(11) So March 30th comes around and they
(12) send some search terms out to UFIT, which I
(13) believe is their discovery process and then
(14) they do the searches on March 30th.

(15) Everything is happening really
(16) quickly. On March 30th at 12:48 p.m., the
(17) search concluded with 103 messages that
(18) resulted in 330 pages.

(19) No one has ever identified what those
(20) records are. They didn't tell me about
(21) them. They didn't tell me anything.

(22) So they find those on March 30th of
(23) 2026, four days after my records request,
(24) and they tell me nothing about it.

(25) I follow up on April 22nd, because I

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(1) had not heard anything and I did a response
(2) saying that it's undergoing legal review.

(3) Some of this information that I have
(4) now is from a second public records request
(5) that sought documentation regarding the
(6) process of responding to my initial public
(7) records request.

(8) That's what proves that there's
(9) documents that the University of Florida is
(10) hiding, that they don't want to identify
(11) and they don't want to answer any questions
(12) about, which is the precise reason that we
(13) have public records access as part of our
(14) constitutional rights in Florida.

(15) We have those rights so that people in
(16) government and the courts don't tyrannize
(17) us or overreach and do things that they're
(18) not supposed to do.

(19) That's why it's important that I get
(20) access to these records is because what the
(21) constitutional provision is designed to do
(22) is actively failing as the Thirteenth
(23) Circuit Courts are allowed to tyrannize me
(24) and my family.

(25) They're forcing a guardian ad litem on

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(1) happy and healthy kids where there's no
(2) concern about anything I've ever done as a
(3) father.

(4) Anyone that will talk to you about
(5) what type of dad I am will say that I'm a
(6) great dad.

(7) And they assume that there must be
(8) something that they're missing when they
(9) hear what the Court is doing to me and
(10) doing to my kids, because they're
(11) delightful, happy and healthy kids, because
(12) I had the audacity to tell the truth and
(13) ask for my rights under the law and object
(14) when they were denigrated, and they're
(15) retaliating against me every way they can.

(16) I apologize that I didn't get you
(17) things faster, but that's part of my
(18) argument here is that the Court system is
(19) trying so hard to protect itself, protect
(20) other insiders, that the amount of work
(21) that they're forcing on me to just protect
(22) my constitutional rights, and it's
(23) absolutely unconscionable.

(24) There's no good-faith basis for what a
(25) lot of courts have done already, and I hope

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(1) that this Court will not follow in that
(2) direction.

(3) Unless Mr. Kirkconnell is able to tell
(4) me that some of the things that I'm saying
(5) are not true, it's not a close call. It's
(6) absolutely outrageous what they've been
(7) allowed to get away with.

(8) So on March 30th, I identified those
(9) 330 pages, but Barbara Wood who is a
(10) paralegal at the general counsel's office
(11) had ten additional pages. So they had
(12) 340 pages.

(13) She's asking the general counsel's
(14) office by March 30th, all of this is
(15) happening March 30th, she asked the general
(16) counsel's office shall I prepare an
(17) invoice.

(18) The general counsel's office responds
(19) and says I think very little of this may be
(20) responsive. So no invoice for now.

(21) And, again, they've never identified
(22) what these records are. So if I don't get
(23) a chance to get some discovery or get these
(24) records, the University of Florida is just
(25) being allowed to hide what they're actually

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(1) doing from the public.

(2) That cannot be what we have out of one
(3) of the preeminent journalist institutions
(4) in Florida, if not the country, we can't
(5) have journalists that are doing the exact
(6) opposite of what they argue in court.

(7) Dr. Collier and I believe Professor
(8) Bambauer makes exactly the same type of
(9) arguments that I'm making here today, yet
(10) they're hiding from accountability, because
(11) it's their records that I'm seeking.

(12) They don't like it when I'm seeking
(13) their public records, but they know that
(14) what I'm saying is the law.

(15) There's plenty of public statements
(16) from them that should outright act as
(17) admissions for the Defendants in this case.

(18) So that's a part that can't be
(19) overstated, that we have the Brechner
(20) Freedom of Information Institute that's
(21) hiding information and hiding from
(22) accountability and hiding from discovery.

(23) So they decide that they're not going
(24) to invoice me. They just think very few of
(25) the records are related or responsive,

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(1) which I don't know what that means.

(2) I don't know who the center is.

(3) There's some reason why the University of
(4) Florida can't even identify what these are,
(5) because they would do that if they were
(6) able to do that and argue that they're just
(7) privileged or covered by an exemption or
(8) that they're not public records.

(9) That's another argument that they make
(10) throughout some of their pleadings is that
(11) some things are just not public records.

(12) If there's anything about me, I
(13) contacted them about precisely what their
(14) business is, what they do at the school,
(15) argue for freedom of information.

(16) So the idea that the University of
(17) Florida is saying that there's anything
(18) about me that is in the University of
(19) Florida's materials would be not a public
(20) record is just silly. It's frivolous and
(21) it's bad-faith.

(22) The course of action makes no sense
(23) with it being anything other than that they
(24) have critically relevant evidence to my
(25) case, because everyone is still hiding from

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(1) accountability, and the Brechner Institute
(2) is doing the same. Yet, their sworn
(3) purpose is to protect people like me.

(4) If the Court is not concerned about
(5) that, then I would ask that the Court to
(6) consider looking further into what's going
(7) on in the underlying cases.

(8) This has been going on almost three
(9) years. There's not an ounce of good faith
(10) in what the Thirteenth Circuit is trying to
(11) do.

(12) I had one request in litigation, some
(13) simple financial discovery and to keep my
(14) kids out of it, to get it done as quickly
(15) as possible.

(16) I was represented by two different law
(17) firms. And Judge Ayers for whatever reason
(18) decided that I wasn't going to get my
(19) rights protected, that they were going to
(20) steamroll anything that I wanted to do,
(21) which is the one thing, which is what makes
(22) the case so perfect for a public records
(23) argument, which is what I presented to Dr.
(24) Collier is that it's a one-issue case in
(25) the underlying litigation.

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(1) Judge Ayers made the video part of the
(2) record, part of the record in the underling
(3) proceedings based upon what she said in the
(4) hearing transcript.

(5) It would be a perfect opportunity for
(6) Brechner to advance their mission, but for
(7) some reason, they went exactly the opposite
(8) way.

(9) They don't send me anything after they
(10) decided that they're not going to invoice
(11) me. I had to respond on April 22nd, which
(12) is about three weeks after -- over three
(13) weeks after they have located this
(14) 340 pages.

(15) And the records custodian, Mr. Hines
(16) e-mails Ms. Amy Quillen. And what she says
(17) is to tell me -- you can let him know that
(18) his request is undergoing the legal review.

(19) So I've got 720 odd pages that relate
(20) to how UF processed my request for records.
(21) There's nothing else about a legal review.

(22) And if the Court looks at the
(23) documents that the University of Florida
(24) provided to me, they only provided my
(25) communications with the University of

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(1) Florida back to me.

(2) They didn't provide any other record
(3) and they didn't tell me that they had any
(4) other records. They said it's closed.

(5) They gave me my own records back on
(6) May 4th and said that they considered the
(7) records request closed.

(8) If you look at what the University of
(9) Florida has now produced on record in this
(10) case, which they filed on a public docket,
(11) there is about 420 pages of records that
(12) are obviously completely unrelated to me.
(13) Just factually, they have nothing at all to
(14) do with me.

(15) They filed those on the public docket,
(16) even though there's some very personal
(17) information and some politically charged
(18) information from professors that they filed
(19) on a public docket, they never revealed
(20) that they had any other records when they
(21) initially just produced my records back to
(22) me.

(23) So immediately it made no sense that
(24) the requests had to go through over a month
(25) of legal review, because all they have

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(1) produced back to me was my own records and
(2) they suggested that was everything.

(3) They didn't say that they withheld
(4) anything, no privilege log, no
(5) identification of any other records. There
(6) was 340 pages on March 30th.

(7) So over a month before they produced
(8) the records, there's 340 pages, and we just
(9) don't know what happened to those, but we
(10) do know what they produced on the docket in
(11) this case is obviously factually unrelated
(12) to me.

(13) So as the University of Florida would
(14) present it to this Court, the records that
(15) they have are my communications with the
(16) University of Florida and the records from
(17) professors at George Washington University
(18) about a conference.

(19) There's no reasonable explanation for
(20) why they take five weeks of legal review
(21) and moments after I sent the public records
(22) request that same day, the records
(23) custodian is asking for a meeting with two
(24) representatives of the general counsel's
(25) office, if all they have is my own

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(1) communication with the University of
(2) Florida and then records related to
(3) professors that I have never heard of
(4) before.

(5) It just doesn't make any sense. It
(6) would be a very simple records response if
(7) that were the case.

(8) You don't need five weeks of legal
(9) review and involvement of the general
(10) counsel's office from the first moment.

(11) So I followed up on May 4th, the same
(12) day that they sent me the 53 pages of my
(13) own communications.

(14) And I say, there's obviously a problem
(15) here, because it does not make any sense
(16) that it took this long.

(17) At that point, they were still telling
(18) me that was everything, which made even
(19) less sense, because if all you had is my
(20) own communications, then obviously they're
(21) not privileged, I already have them.

(22) So I responded to them on May 4th and
(23) they eventually get back to me on May 8th,
(24) but what happens between then is important.

(25) And I believe that is --

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(1) MR. KIRKCONNELL: Your Honor, I hate
(2) to interrupt, but we're running out of
(3) time.

(4) THE COURT: Yes. We are running out
(5) of time, and I was actually going to say
(6) that.

(7) Mr. Hanson, we have six minutes left.
(8) I'm trying to actually do the math since my
(9) laptop has the wrong time on it.

(10) We have five minutes left. You spent
(11) quite a bit of time responding. I'm going
(12) to ask you to wrap up your argument in the
(13) next minute so that Mr. Kirkconnell can
(14) respond.

(15) MR. HANSON: The next minute, Your
(16) Honor?

(17) THE COURT: Yes.

(18) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, there is so
(19) much more misconduct that needs to be
(20) reviewed here.

(21) THE COURT: We're not here about
(22) misconduct, sir.

(23) MR. HANSON: We are.

(24) THE COURT: We're here about a Motion
(25) for Protective Order. And I've asked you

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(1) to respond specifically to what's raised in
(2) that Motion for Protective Order.

(3) If you have any case law that supports
(4) your position that you're entitled to
(5) discovery, now would be the best time to
(6) present that to the Court.

(7) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I don't think
(8) I have a chance --

(9) THE COURT: You have a minute to wrap
(10) it up.

(11) MR. HANSON: I don't believe that
(12) you'll give me a fair chance. I think that
(13) you are beholden to powers that are
(14) internal.

(15) You've already tried to sweep this
(16) under the rug. You don't want to hear the
(17) facts.

(18) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, personally
(19) attacking me is not going to help you. I
(20) am more than happy to listen to your
(21) argument.

(22) The issue is that half an hour was set
(23) for today and I have other hearings
(24) scheduled for the whole day.

(25) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, you said

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(1) yourself it wasn't set right.

(2) THE COURT: I said it should not have
(3) even been set for a case management
(4) conference.

(5) There were two hearings noticed for
(6) today. I'm trying to rule on those motions
(7) that are set for hearing.

(8) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I think that
(9) it's pretty incredible that we have these
(10) types of problems with institutions in the
(11) Florida judiciary, and this Court is so
(12) quick to silence me.

(13) THE COURT: I'm not quick to silence
(14) you, Mr. Hanson.

(15) MR. HANSON: You are, Your Honor.

(16) THE COURT: Mr. Hanson, yelling at me
(17) is not appropriate.

(18) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I'm not
(19) yelling at you.

(20) THE COURT: You are yelling at me.

(21) MR. HANSON: I'm frustrated, but I'm
(22) not yelling.

(23) THE COURT: And the court reporter
(24) can't get an accurate record when we're
(25) both talking.

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(1) So it's very important that you let me
(2) talk and I will let you talk, which I have
(3) done for the last ten minutes or so.

(4) I have tried to direct you in the
(5) beginning of your argument to please
(6) respond to the Motion for Protective Order.

(7) You've gone well outside of that. You
(8) wanted to give me the history. I've let
(9) you do that.

(10) All I know about your case is what's
(11) in the pleadings that have been filed. I
(12) don't know anything about your history.

(13) So I appreciate you giving me that
(14) background, but again, when you set a
(15) hearing and we have a limited amount of
(16) time, I have to hold you to that time,
(17) because I have other hearings scheduled
(18) back-to-back for the day.

(19) MR. HANSON: I would ask that it be
(20) rescheduled to be continued at a later time
(21) or that the Court --

(22) THE COURT: Well, scheduling it for a
(23) continuance at a later time does not make
(24) sense when the other motion pending is a
(25) request for an immediate hearing, which I

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(1) agree, you're entitled to an immediate
(2) hearing.

(3) Rather than requesting a case
(4) management conference, it should have been
(5) scheduled for an immediate hearing.

(6) MR. HANSON: No. I need discovery,
(7) Your Honor. You're just letting them sweep
(8) it under the rug.

(9) THE COURT: I'm not letting anyone
(10) sweep anything under the rug, sir. You
(11) have a minute. Go ahead and use that
(12) however you like.

(13) MR. HANSON: On May 7th, so after
(14) they've already told me this is everything
(15) and before they respond to my concern also
(16) raised on May 4th, the same day that they
(17) responded with the 53 pages of my own
(18) communications, on May 7th, suddenly they
(19) run a search on Ms. Bambauer's e-mail. And
(20) the tool stalled out on March 9th and
(21) doesn't pick up anything after that.

(22) My first contact with the University
(23) of Florida was March 12th. So the tool
(24) phased out three days before the relevant
(25) period, and there's nothing suggesting that

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(1) they ever went back and did that search.

(2) It almost appears that they did that
(3) search to create the pretense of we found
(4) records that involve a different Hanson.
(5) They did it on March 7th and then they
(6) identified I believe 100 some pages.

(7) The records custodian then sends me a
(8) very bizarre message on March 8th saying
(9) that we found some other records with
(10) Hanson, but it involves individuals who are
(11) not you, which I'm not asking for every
(12) document that has Hanson on it.

(13) I'm asking for stuff related to my
(14) case. It's an obvious pretense, especially
(15) when the Court considers that even when
(16) they filed this response to the Order to
(17) show cause, they still hadn't identified
(18) the specific number of pages that they had
(19) identified in the search.

(20) They had all of this information.
(21) There may be as many as 1,000 pages. It's
(22) difficult to tell if there may be
(23) duplicates, but clearly, there's more than
(24) what they have shown.

(25) They tried to pass the 52 pages as my

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(1) correspondence off as everything. I called
(2) them on that.

(3) Then they had this plan about, well,
(4) there's stuff that we found for Hanson, for
(5) individuals who are not you. That doesn't
(6) make any sense.

(7) They're just trying to throw things at
(8) the wall and avoid answering for these
(9) things, where clearly the records custodian
(10) hasn't even sworn a precise number of
(11) pages.

(12) The only thing that we have from the
(13) University of Florida that's actually sworn
(14) is that there's over 470 pages.

(15) I don't know of any reason why a state
(16) institution in responding to an Order to
(17) show cause in a case where I've been clear
(18) that I think that they have things that
(19) they're not showing me and not even
(20) identify an accurate number of pages.
(21) That's reason enough to have discovery
(22) right there.

(23) MR. KIRKCONNELL: Your Honor.

(24) THE COURT: Thank you. Mr.

(25) Kirkconnell. Your time is up, Mr. Hanson.

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(1) MR. HANSON: I will add that there's a
(2) lot more that needs to be addressed here
(3) and I hope the Court will look at it. The
(4) case law is all in the motions and
(5) responses.

(6) THE COURT: Thank you. Mr.
(7) Kirkconnell.

(8) MR. KIRKCONNELL: Thank you, Your
(9) Honor. Two things. First of all, I
(10) already know I'm on borrowed time so I
(11) appreciate the Court allowing me to make an
(12) argument.

(13) Secondly, I did hear Mr. Hanson raise
(14) his voice with you. I just want to make
(15) that clear for the record.

(16) I want to say four things about the
(17) Motion for Protective Order and I'm
(18) reframing what I said in the motion itself.
(19) I'll keep this brief, Your Honor.

(20) First, this is a use by Petitioner to
(21) shift the burden of proof onto the
(22) University of Florida.

(23) The way mandamus works is once the
(24) pleadings are closed, it's not the agency's
(25) burden anymore. It's the Petitioner's

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(1) burden.

(2) There are four elements. And this is
(3) in the case of the Executive Office of the
(4) Governor v. Florida Center for Government
(5) Accountability, Fla. So2d 839. It's a
(6) First DCA case, 2025. There's four
(7) elements.

(8) If the record exists and that the
(9) agency didn't produce it. Mr. Hanson
(10) cannot show that the records exist.

(11) He said that repeatedly today. It's
(12) also in his motions, that this is pure
(13) speculation, that he believes the records
(14) exist based on his own conspiracy theories
(15) and the way he looks at this case.

(16) So by forcing UF to prove a negative
(17) through discovery, he's shifting the burden
(18) improperly.

(19) The second reason that the discovery
(20) is improper is that Mr. Hanson is using the
(21) litigation process to impose duties on the
(22) University which are not part of Chapter
(23) 119.

(24) Courts are clear that you cannot
(25) expand the duties of an agency beyond what

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(1) Chapter 119 says.

(2) He's asked for certification of a
(3) diligence search. He's asked for a
(4) privilege log.

(5) These are things that are accomplished
(6) through litigation. So he's essentially
(7) using litigation to get what he wants.

(8) Your Honor, that's improper. It also
(9) sets a bad precedent. It could lead to
(10) other litigants doing the same thing.

(11) Third, Mr. Hanson is using litigation
(12) to substantiate ultimate facts. That's
(13) backwards.

(14) You don't use litigation or discovery
(15) in litigation as a fishing expedition to
(16) substantiate allegations of ultimate fact.
(17) I have a case cited in the motion to that
(18) effect.

(19) Lastly, it's just beyond the scope of
(20) the issues that are before the Court right
(21) now.

(22) The issue is did the University comply
(23) with 119.071(C) specifically. I'm not
(24) going to go through the elements of that,
(25) but we've shown that we have.

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(1) This is not within the scope. So the
(2) discovery is an undue burden on the
(3) University. And we respectfully request
(4) that the Court issue a protective order
(5) pending the outcome of the immediate
(6) hearing that we've already discussed.

(7) Your Honor, I appreciate the time.
(8) Thank you. That's all I have.

(9) THE COURT: Thank you. I am going to
(10) grant the Motion for Protective Order. I
(11) do believe it's outside the scope.

(12) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I'd like to
(13) make an oral motion to disqualify you. I
(14) think that you're corrupt and you're
(15) dishonest and you are trying to protect
(16) insiders and I think you should be off of
(17) my case.

(18) THE COURT: And that ore tenus motion
(19) will be denied.

(20) MR. HANSON: Okay. I'm going to file
(21) a formal motion as well.

(22) THE COURT: You may file whatever
(23) motions you would like, Mr. Hanson. As far
(24) as scheduling you for an immediate hearing,
(25) which should be done at this point, how

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(1) much time --

(2) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I'm going to
(3) be appealing this.

(4) THE COURT: Excuse me?

(5) MR. HANSON: I'm going to be appealing
(6) your refusal to disqualify yourself and the
(7) granting of the motion for protective
(8) order.

(9) If we have to set it, we can, but my
(10) schedule is incredibly busy and it's going
(11) to go to the appellate court first.

(12) THE COURT: That's fine. I will have
(13) my assistant reach out regarding scheduling
(14) of the hearing.

(15) MR. HANSON: Your Honor, I need to put
(16) on the record that I served discovery back
(17) in August.

(18) THE COURT: Sir, there's no additional
(19) time on the record. As I previously said,
(20) I have other parties waiting for another
(21) hearing.

(22) MR. HANSON: You're protecting the
(23) University of Florida.

(24) THE COURT: I'm not protecting anyone.
(25) Sir, I am protecting the parties who are

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(1) scheduled for a hearing immediately after
(2) this hearing, which I'm running late to,
(3) because I already gave you additional time.
(4) That is it for the hearing today. Thank
(5) you.

(6) (The hearing concluded at 11:37 a.m.
(7) on August 24, 2026.)

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(1) CERTIFICATE OF REPORTER

(2)

(3) STATE OF FLORIDA)

(4) COUNTY OF PINELLAS)

(5)

(6) I, MARY ANN BROWNE, Court Reporter, and
(7) Notary Public, do hereby certify that I was
(8) authorized to and did stenographically report
(9) the foregoing hearing; and that the foregoing
(10) transcript is a true record of my stenographic
(11) notes.

(12) I FURTHER CERTIFY that I am not a relative,
(13) employee, or attorney, or counsel of any of the
(14) parties' attorneys or counsel connected with the
(15) action, nor am I financially interested in the
(16) action.

(17) DATED August 28, 2026, Pinellas County,
(18) Florida.

(19)

(20)

(21)

Mary Ann Browne
MARY ANN BROWNE

(22)

Notary Public

(23)

(24)

(25)



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